

4.6

Checking understanding

Worksheet

A Read part of a conversation between two people discussing working from home.

- A:** I used to work from home while my children were young, but I didn't really like it.
B: I don't understand. What didn't you like? I've always wanted to work from home.
A: Perhaps I didn't explain very well. Let me put it another way. I suppose I missed the teamwork, having other people to discuss ideas with.
B: So in other words you felt isolated and missed the social contact. Is that right?
A: Yes, exactly.
B: I'd be happy to spend more time working at home. I'm tired of all the office politics at Finance International. And I hate my journey to work every morning.
A: What do you mean? I thought you had a good relationship with your colleagues. Do you want to change jobs?
B: No, sorry, that's not really what I meant. In fact I love my work. But I'd like the chance to do a bit more work from home.
A: So are you saying you want more variety and more control over your time?
B: Yes, I suppose so.

Underline phrases used for checking understanding and clarifying in the dialogue above.

Work in small groups. Discuss your ideas on working from home. Check that you understand exactly what other people mean using phrases from the dialogue and your own questions.

B Match the beginnings and endings of these phrases.

- | | | |
|-------|--|--------------------------------|
| _____ | { 1 Sorry, could you say ... | ... you say 'office politics'. |
| _____ | { 2 I'm sorry, I didn't ... | ... that again please? |
| _____ | { 3 I don't understand what you mean when ... | ... catch that. |
| _____ | { 4 Could you be a little ... | ... more specific? |
| _____ | { 5 So, in other words, you felt isolated. Is ... | ... that right? |
| _____ | { 6 Are you ... | ... put it another way. |
| _____ | { 7 Perhaps I didn't explain very well. Let me ... | ... what I meant. |
| _____ | { 8 No, sorry, that's not really ... | ... saying ...? |

Write the headings in the box on the appropriate lines above.

Using your own words to check Asking for repetition
Asking for more information Replying: apologizing then clarifying

C Work in small groups. Each person in turn choose a topic from the list (or one of your own) and discuss it with your group. Check understanding very carefully. When you finish you will have to explain to a new partner what your colleagues said.

- A complex project I once worked on.
- A complex process in my factory/office.
- The election system in my country.
- One thing in my national culture I am proud of, and one I am not proud of.